



TorqueWorks POS

NETLIFY SETUP GUIDE

Hosting the app & its database on Netlify · v1.1

What this guide covers: importing the TorqueWorks point-of-sale system into Netlify, where it runs as a website with a built-in database (Netlify Blobs) — no server to rent or maintain. Two ways to deploy, how the database works, a tour of the day-to-day features (pricing, flat-rate presets, discounts, crew tabs and the repair database), bringing in existing data, locking it down, custom domains, and backups. No prior experience assumed.

0 How it works

A quick mental model before you start.

Netlify is not a database — it hosts websites and runs small "serverless" helpers. TorqueWorks on Netlify is made of three pieces that work together:

- **The app** (`public/index.html`) — served as a website, with HTTPS handled for you automatically.
- **A small function** (`netlify/functions/kv.js`) — saves and loads your data.
- **Netlify Blobs** — Netlify's built-in storage. **This is your database.** There is nothing to install; Netlify provides it.

When an employee uses the app, it calls `/api/kv/...`, which Netlify routes to the function, which reads and writes Netlify Blobs. Everyone who opens the site shares the same live data.

WHY THIS IS NICE

No server to rent, patch, or keep running; automatic HTTPS (so the checkout Copy buttons work); a public web address out of the box; and a free tier that's plenty for a single shop.

1 What you'll need

- The **TorqueWorks Netlify bundle** — the `torqueworks-netlify` folder (unzip `torqueworks-netlify.zip`).
- A free **Netlify account** (sign up at `app.netlify.com`).
- **Optional:** a domain name if you want a custom address instead of `your-site.netlify.app` .

Inside the bundle:

```
torqueworks-netlify/  
  public/index.html  ← the app  
  netlify/functions/kv.js  ← saves & loads data  
  netlify.toml       ← routes /api/* to the function  
  package.json       ← tells Netlify to add the Blobs library
```

2 Import & deploy — drag-and-drop

The simplest way. No tools, no command line.

1. Unzip `torqueworks-netlify.zip` so you have the `torqueworks-netlify` folder.
2. Go to `app.netlify.com` and sign in.
3. Click **Add new site → Deploy manually**.
4. Drag the whole **torqueworks-netlify** folder onto the upload area.
5. Netlify uploads it, installs the database library, and publishes. After a moment you'll get a live address like **your-site.netlify.app**.

TIP

Drag the **folder** itself, not the files inside it — Netlify needs to see `netlify.toml` and the `netlify/functions` folder to wire up the database.

RENAME YOUR SITE

The first URL is random. In **Site configuration → Change site name** you can set something like `torqueworks-yourshop`, giving you `torqueworks-yourshop.netlify.app`.

3 Import & deploy — from GitHub auto-updates

Prefer automatic redeloys whenever the app changes? Use Git instead of drag-and-drop.

1. Put the contents of the `torqueworks-netlify` folder into a GitHub repository.
2. In Netlify: **Add new site → Import an existing project**, and choose your repo.
3. Settings: **Build command** = leave blank, **Publish directory** = `public`. Deploy.

From then on, every push to the repo redeloys the site automatically.

4 The database (Netlify Blobs)

Good news: there is nothing to set up.

The function stores everything in a Netlify Blobs store named `torqueworks`. Blobs is enabled automatically for your deployed function — no provisioning, no connection strings, no passwords to manage. Your seven datasets live there:

What	Stored as
Shop settings & permissions	bbpos:settings
Employees	bbpos:emps
Parts catalog	bbpos:parts
Charges & invoices	bbpos:tx
Money in / out	bbpos:ledger
Repair-tool database	bbpos:repairs
Clock-in / clock-out hours	bbpos:shifts

4.1 Verify it's saving

Open your site, create the first employee, then visit `https://your-site.netlify.app/api/backup` in your browser. If you see JSON with your data in it, the database is working. (This same link is also your one-click backup — see Section 8.)

IF YOU SEE A BLOBS / 500 ERROR

Open `Site → Functions → kv` and check the logs. Make sure the deploy finished successfully and that `package.json` was included (it tells Netlify to install the Blobs library). Re-deploying the full folder usually clears it.

5 First run

1. Open your site's address. The first time, it asks you to create the first employee — this is the **Boss** (full access).
2. Log in with that State ID and the default password, then set your own password when prompted.
3. Add your crew in `Admin → Crew`, and set who can see what in `Admin → Access Control`.
4. Send everyone the site link — they log in and you're all working from the same live data.

6 Day-to-day: pricing, tabs & the repair database

6.1 How pricing works

The register is built around a simple, profit-first model — there is **no sales tax** anywhere.

- **Parts** are entered at their **cost**. The customer is charged that cost plus an **upcharge** (default **20%**), and that upcharge is the profit on parts.
- **Labour / flat-rate charges** are counted as **pure profit**.
- **Commission** is a share of **profit**: **40%** for Apprentices (trainees) and **50%** for Mechanics and Managers. Each person can also be given a custom rate.

All three numbers — the upcharge % and the two commission rates — live in [Admin → Settings](#).

EXAMPLE

A \$100 part + a \$200 flat-rate job → customer pays **\$320**, profit is **\$220**, and a 50% mechanic earns **\$110**.

6.2 Flat-rate quick-add presets

On the register, the **Flat-rate quick add** panel is a searchable grid of preset jobs. Each preset has a **Part \$** and a **Labour \$**; tapping it drops a part line (Part \$ = cost, charged at cost + upcharge) *and* a labour line (Labour \$ = pure profit) into the cart. Edit the presets in [Admin → Settings → Flat-rate quick-add presets](#).

6.3 Preset discounts

Add named discounts (e.g. “Loyalty 10%”) in [Admin → Settings → Preset discounts](#). They appear as a dropdown on the register. A discount lowers the customer's total **and** comes out of profit, so the mechanic's commission drops with it.

6.4 Tabs & billing cycles

A **Tab** is a running balance for a repeat customer or crew (BCSO, EMS, a towing company, etc.). Open the [Tabs](#) section to create one with a name, optional notes, and a billing cycle in days (default 14).

- On the register, pick a tab from the **Tab** dropdown to attach a job to it.
- The Tabs list shows each tab's order count, running total, days left in the cycle, and a status that flips to **“Invoice required”** when the cycle ends.
- **Mark invoiced** resets the cycle (and logs it), **Archive** hides a finished tab, and **Delete** removes it (the jobs stay, they just lose the tab link).

You can also give any job a **Job title** and **Notes** on the register; both show up on the Charges/Invoices lists.

6.5 The repair database

The [Repair Tool](#) ships preloaded with **50+ parts across 7 zones** (Engine Bay Top/Bottom, Underside Front/Center/Rear, Wheel Hub, Security). Pick a zone and a part and it shows the **equipment** needed (lift, hoist...), the **replace-when** threshold, and the full **tool list**.

Bosses and Managers can edit any entry, add new ones, or re-load the built-in set with **Load default database**. The whole database travels with your backups, and you can bulk-edit it as a spreadsheet via [Admin → Copy / paste data](#) using the columns [zone](#), [part](#), [equipment](#), [replacewhen](#), [tools](#).

7 Bringing existing data in

Already have shop data (e.g. from testing the app earlier)? Move it over in two minutes:

1. From the old copy, open [Admin → Copy / paste data](#) and **export** the full dataset (you'll get a block of JSON), or open your old [data.json](#) file.
2. On the new Netlify site, log in as the Boss and open [Admin → Copy / paste data](#).
3. Paste the JSON into the **import** box and import. It writes straight into the Netlify Blobs database.

NOTE

You can also import employees, parts, or invoices individually from a spreadsheet (TSV/CSV) on the same screen.

8 Lock down the API

Worth doing, since the site is public.

By default, anyone who knows the address could read or write data through `/api/kv/`. To stop that, set a shared secret:

1. In Netlify: [Site configuration → Environment variables → Add a variable](#) — name it `TW_TOKEN`, value a long random string.
2. The app must send that same token, so you'll need an `index.html` with the token baked in. Drop that file into `public/` and re-deploy.

IMPORTANT

If you set `TW_TOKEN` in Netlify but don't use the matching token-baked `index.html`, the app will get "unauthorized" errors. Set both, or neither.

Also: every employee signs in with their State ID and their own password. Set a non-obvious default in [Admin → Security](#) and have each person change it on first login. Passwords are stored in plain text, so don't keep real personal information in the system.

9 Custom domain, backups & updates

9.1 Your own domain

In [Domain management → Add a domain](#), enter your domain and follow the DNS steps. Netlify issues HTTPS for it automatically. (The free `.netlify.app` address already has HTTPS.)

9.2 Backups

Visit `https://your-site.netlify.app/api/backup` any time to download a full JSON snapshot, or use the in-app [Admin → Copy / paste data](#) export. Keep periodic copies somewhere safe.

9.3 Updating the app

When you get a new version, re-drag the folder (manual deploy) or push to GitHub. Your data in Netlify Blobs is never touched by an update.

10 Quick-start checklist

- ☐ Unzip the `torqueworks-netlify` folder
- ☐ Sign in at `app.netlify.com`
- ☐ **Add new site → Deploy manually**, drag the folder in
- ☐ Wait for the deploy — note your `your-site.netlify.app` address
- ☐ (Optional) rename the site to something memorable
- ☐ Open it, create the Boss, set passwords & access control
- ☐ Tweak the upcharge %, commission rates, flat-rate presets & discounts in Admin
- ☐ Set up any crew **Tabs**; the repair database is already loaded
- ☐ Check `/api/backup` shows your data (database is working)
- ☐ (Recommended) set `TW_TOKEN` + deploy the token-baked app
- ☐ (Optional) add a custom domain
- ☐ Send the crew the link — done

11 Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause & fix
Deploy succeeds but data never saves	Open Functions → kv logs. Usually the folder was dragged without <code>netlify.toml</code> / <code>package.json</code> — re-deploy the whole folder.
"unauthorized" / 401 errors	<code>TW_TOKEN</code> is set in Netlify but the app doesn't have the matching token baked in. Set both or neither.
Everyone sees an empty register	They must all use the same site URL, not a downloaded copy of the HTML file.
Opening index.html on a computer shows "Failed to save"	That's the file opened with no site behind it. Use the deployed Netlify address instead.
Copy buttons do nothing	Use the <code>https://</code> Netlify address (clipboard needs HTTPS).

